University of Prishtina

Faculty of Electrical and Computer Engineering

Second Intrusion Report

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Prishtinë, 2026

Contents

Table of Figures 3
Table of Tables 3
Flags and Services 4
Active System and Services 4
Public services exposed (Team 9): 5
Logs explaining 5
Observed Activity Summary 7
Mitigating Actions 7
Conclusion 7

Table of Figures

Figure 1: Flags status in IScorE 4
Figure 2: Logs from Elastic Stack 6
Figure 3: Discovery of the logs on the Servers 6

Table of Tables

Table 1: Team 9 Public Services Exposure 5

Flags and Services

This report documents Team 9's monitoring observations and incident response actions during the second reporting window (Feb. 21, 2026, 11:00 a.m. - 12:30 p.m.). During this period, Team 9 maintained full service availability and observed no confirmed unauthorized access resulting in flag compromise or service disruption.

- Flag status: Based on the scoreboard/flag monitoring view, all Team 9 flags remained secure (no claimed flags) throughout the window. We validated this by checking the competition status view and by verifying that flag files in their expected locations remained unchanged (timestamps and hashes).
- Service status: All exposed services remained reachable and responsive. We continuously monitored service health checks and log telemetry for signs of abuse (scanning, brute-force attempts, abnormal HTTP requests). No service outage events were recorded during this reporting window.

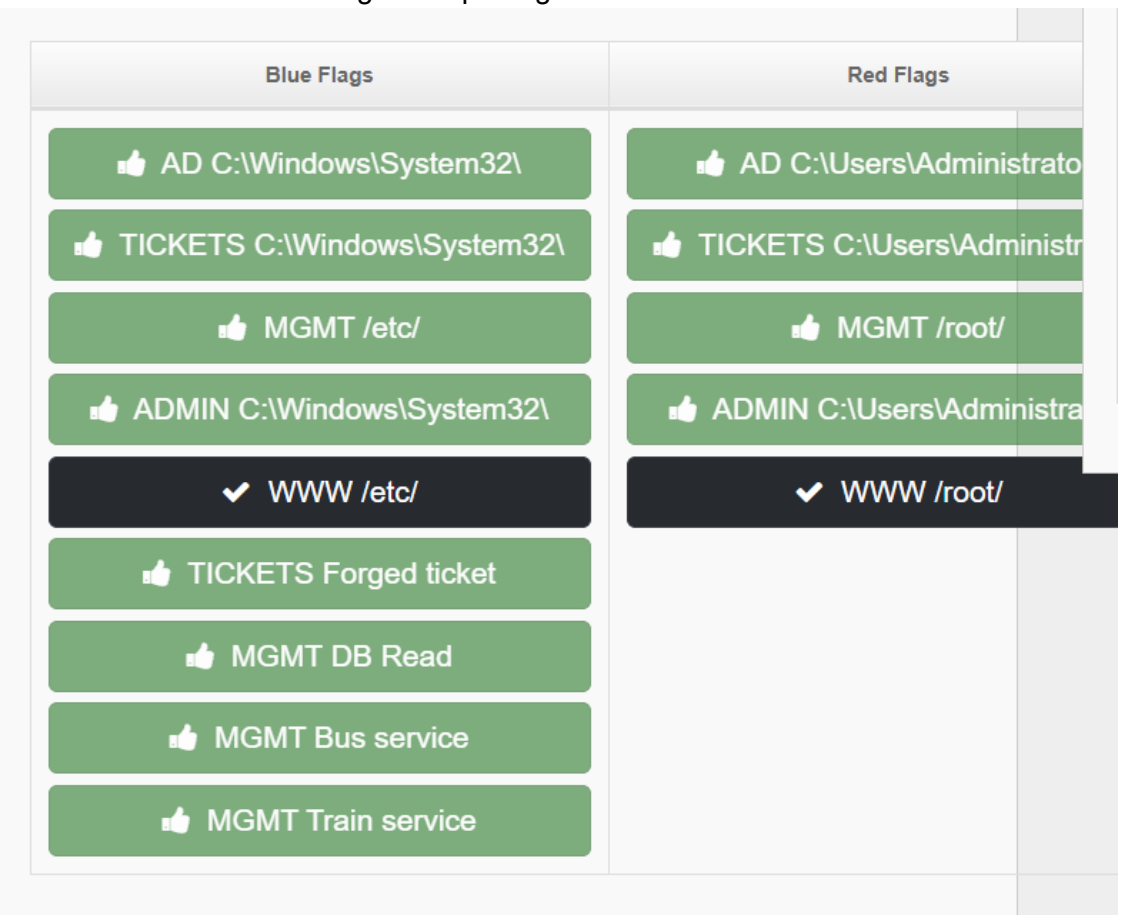

Figure 1: Flags status in IScorE

Active System and Services

The analysis confirms that the system and services are currently active and operational. Through comprehensive monitoring and assessment, no confirmed indicators of unauthorized entry were

detected during the reporting window. This suggests that the implemented security measures have effectively safeguarded the system's infrastructure from external threats and unauthorized access.

Public services exposed (Team 9):

Table 1: Team 9 Public Services Exposure

Domain Name	Public IP	Port(s)
ad.team9.isucdc.com	33.96.50.10	3389, 389, 636
tickets.team9.isucdc.com	33.96.50.20	3389, 5000
mgmt.team9.isucdc.com	33.96.50.30	22, 5000
admin.team9.isucdc.com	33.96.50.40	3389, 80
www.team9.isucdc.com	33.96.50.50	22, 80

Logs explaining

This section summarizes key observations from centralized logging (Elastic Stack), IDS/IPS alerts (Suricata), firewall events (pfSense), Windows authentication telemetry (AD/Tickets/Admin), Linux authentication telemetry (MGMT/WWW), and web/application access logs. Screenshots or exports referenced as figures should be attached in the final submission.

During the reporting window, reviewed telemetry showed routine system and administrative activity only. We did not observe indicators consistent with intrusion attempts, including brute-force behavior, password spraying, exploitation, or abnormal web requests. No evidence of successful authentication by unauthorized users, privilege escalation, persistence mechanisms, or flag access was identified.

On the management server (mgmt.team9.isucdc.com), Linux authentication logs showed no repeated failed SSH authentication attempts and no anomalous access patterns. Where administrative access occurred, it aligned with expected operations and scheduled checks. Correlation with firewall and IDS/IPS telemetry did not reveal any follow-on actions or suspicious

sequences of events.

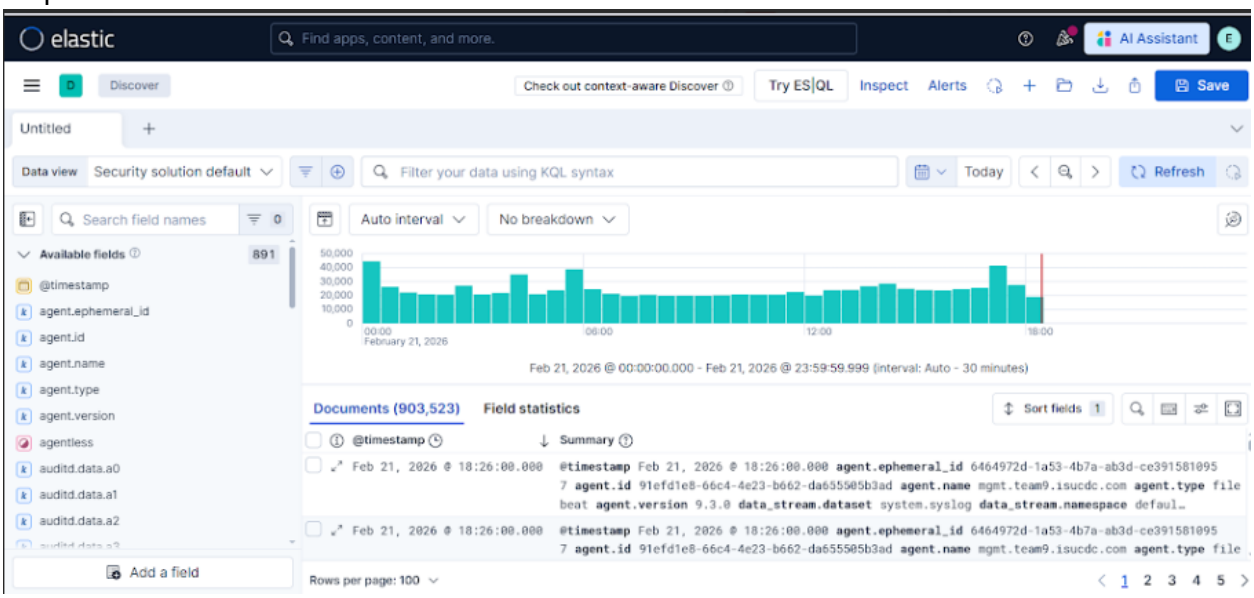

Figure 2: Logs from Elastic Stack

After reviewing authentication logs from Windows systems (ad.team9.isucdc.com, tickets.team9.isucdc.com, admin.team9.isucdc.com), we observed a mixture of interactive and network logon events consistent with normal operation. System processes and service accounts generated routine logons, and no suspicious user creation, group membership changes, privilege assignment anomalies, or unexpected login sources were identified in the reviewed window.

Correlation across hosts shows routine network activity on the AD and application servers, including expected service-to-service communications. Any externally sourced traffic observed in the logs was consistent with normal background connectivity and did not trigger high-confidence IDS/IPS alerts. Overall, the reviewed sample did not progress to any confirmed unauthorized access.

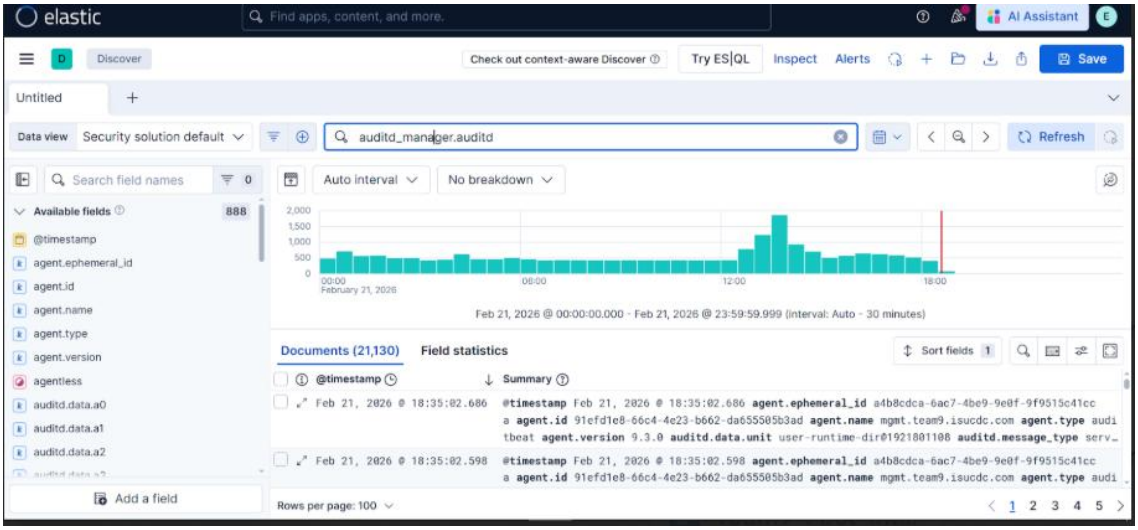

Figure 3: Discovery of the logs on the Servers

Observed Activity Summary

We observed no suspicious activity during the reporting window. Log telemetry did not indicate scanning, brute-force attempts, repeated failed logins, or abnormal HTTP/application requests against Team 9 public services. IDS/IPS and firewall events did not show intrusion signatures or sustained hostile traffic patterns. No successful unauthorized authentication events were detected, and there were no indicators of privilege escalation, persistence, lateral movement, or flag access.

Mitigating Actions

Because no confirmed intrusion occurred during this reporting window, no major remediation was required. However, Team 9 executed standard defensive actions to reduce risk and to validate that protections remained effective:

- Continuous monitoring: Reviewed Elastic Security alerts and endpoint logs at regular intervals; investigated spikes in authentication failures or scan activity.
- Authentication hardening: Ensured strong credential hygiene, minimized exposed accounts, and maintained controls such as disabling direct root login and restricting remote access to necessary users only.
- Network filtering: Maintained pfSense deny rules and rate-limits to reduce brute-force impact; verified blocks were triggering for repeated offenders.
- Service hygiene: Verified that publicly exposed services were running expected versions/configurations and that unnecessary services remained disabled.
- Integrity checks: Verified critical paths and flag locations for unexpected modification (timestamps/hashes) and reviewed cron/systemd for persistence mechanisms.
- Documentation: Recorded indicators (top source IPs, ports, alert signatures) for future tuning and faster triage in subsequent windows.

Conclusion

Based on the reviewed telemetry from Elastic Stack, Suricata, pfSense, Windows and Linux authentication logs, and host-level integrity checks, Team 9 systems remained operational and no confirmed intrusions were identified during the second reporting window. We observed only unsuccessful probing activity (scans and repeated login attempts), which was contained by existing controls and did not progress to unauthorized access or flag compromise. Continued monitoring, alert tuning, and strong authentication practices remain essential to reduce the likelihood and impact of future attempts in upcoming competition windows.

Scoreboard verification and file integrity checks (timestamps/hashes) supported the conclusion that no flags were accessed or modified during the window.